



July 2026 Report

There's a squeeze happening in markets, money, and the economy right now:

First, the rate cuts we saw in 2025 have stopped. The Fed held rates steady again in June - its fourth hold in a row - and hinted the next move is more likely up than down. Central banks in Europe and Japan are even nudging their rates higher.

When rates stay high for a long stretch, they punish any company that leans on loans - even the healthy ones - dragging their stocks far below what the businesses are actually worth.

At the same time, oil prices are falling - but demand for natural gas is booming. Data centers, a growing power grid, and rising liquefied natural gas (LNG) shipments all run on gas, and none of that demand disappears because oil had a bad week.

When oil dropped in June, the market dipped the companies that move that gas right along with it - even though their business didn't change.

And here at home, a word Wall Street hasn't used in about 50 years is back: Stagflation. Prices are rising, paychecks aren't keeping up, and the economy is slowing - all at once.

Even the old bond shelter is leaking, with Washington on pace for a \$1.9 trillion deficit pushing bond yields up and bond prices down.

These are what we call Broad Market Shifts - macro forces big enough to move whole markets and economies at once. Each one opens a different door:

- High Rates for Longer - for investors chasing growth at a discount.
- The Gas Demand Boom - for investors who want steady income.
- Stagflation - for investors who want to protect their wealth.

Today we'll break down one opportunity for each - names our analysts are actually adding to our portfolio:

**Growth:** Nu Holdings (NU)

**Income:** ONEOK (OKE)

**Protection:** Franco-Nevada (FNV)

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### What's Driving Gas Demand

Data centers: ~40,000 acres of new sites within 5 years, mostly powered by natural gas

Electric power: a growing U.S. grid that leans on gas to keep up

LNG exports: rising overseas shipments of U.S. natural gas

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## GROWTH | NU HOLDINGS (NU)

Nu Holdings is what's called a neobank - a digital-first bank that lives mostly online, with no branches to walk into.

It was built for everyday people across Latin America who never had solid banking choices before. Its customer count just topped 135 million, and it now ranks as one of the largest financial institutions in all of Brazil.

Here's the disconnect: Nu's shares are off about 24% in 2026. During that time, though, profit rose 41% and the bank signed up four million fresh customers in a single three-month span.

Why the dip? Brazil's economy has cooled off a little, and Nu stashed away extra cash to cover loans that might not get repaid - which scared some investors out of the stock.

Our analysts read that as the price of growing fast in a developing market - not proof that something's broken.



- The stock trades at about 14 times its earnings, even as the business expands at nearly 40% a year.

For growth investors who think the market is making a mistake here, NU may be a potential opportunity worth watching.

**Exit Trigger:** Should Nu's return on equity slip out of the high-20s, or should customer growth dry up, its profits could take a hit and this opportunity could lose steam.

## INCOME | ONEOK (OKE)

When oil prices swing, the market trades everything with "energy" in the name as one block - including companies that don't actually depend on the price of oil.

ONEOK is one of them. It owns pipelines that move natural gas, plus facilities that gather raw gas straight from the ground and clean it up so it can be used.

Pipelines collect a set fee to move gas - no matter what that gas sells for - and those fees are locked in through contracts that often run for decades. So when oil falls, an oil driller earns less. A pipeline just keeps collecting its tolls.

Meanwhile, demand for the gas in those pipes is booming - from data centers to a growing power grid to rising LNG exports.

- ONEOK pays a dividend yield around 4.8% - steady income backed by those locked-in fees.

For income investors who want to get paid on gas demand instead of gas prices, OKE may be a potential opportunity to keep an eye on.

**Exit Trigger:** Keep an eye on ONEOK's debt. If it keeps climbing, or if falling gas prices start eating into its cash, that could be a reason for investors to consider stepping back.



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## WEALTH PRESERVATION | FRANCO-NEVADA (FNV)

When bonds can't play defense, investors reach for a store of value no government can print: Gold.

History shows that gold prices actually grow during stagflation, and demand is already rising - central banks scooped up 244 tonnes of the metal in Q1 2026 alone.

Franco-Nevada is a way to ride that wave without owning a single mine. It's a royalty company - it hands miners cash upfront, then collects a slice of their sales for years to come.

It gets paid off the top line. So rising fuel, labor, and equipment costs are the miners' problem, not Franco-Nevada's - shielding it from the very inflation this shift is about.

- Profit margins (EBITDA) above 90%, and zero debt on the books.

There's also a setup on the price side: Gold has pulled back about 25% from its 2026 high, and Franco-Nevada trades about 27% below its own high right alongside it - the hedge itself is on sale.

For investors focused on protecting their wealth, FNV may be a potential opportunity worth watching.

**Exit Trigger:** This hedge could lose value if core inflation stays under 2.5% for a few months, the Fed turns friendly, or central banks stop buying gold. A slide in gold under about \$3,700 would be another cue to step back.



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### How These Shifts Could Change

None of these is a sure thing. Beyond each company's own warning signs above, all three ride a big Broad Market Shift that could play out slower - or differently - than expected.

Rates could stay high even longer than people expect, the whole energy group could stay out of favor, or everything could simply turn out fine - inflation falls, the economy grows again, and the defensive names trail the market.

So treat each pick as a single piece of a bigger plan, not the whole plan.

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## Money Is Always Moving

Three Broad Market Shifts are squeezing the world's money: rates staying higher for longer, a gas demand boom the market is ignoring, and stagflation back home.

The good news? You don't have to bet on just one. Nu leans into growth, ONEOK pays you income, and Franco-Nevada plays defense - one name for each way the economy might turn next.

For investors who want a simple way to watch all three shifts at once, these are the names to keep an eye on.

And we're covering even more tickers in our higher tiers - get the full breakdowns by [upgrading to Briefs Pro here](#).



### - Briefs Finance Team

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Included interviews have been edited for length and clarity.